



5-24-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_oo6dVmDX_s
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Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 17, 2022

Body: Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at 5:00 PM by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill (President), Mr. Heater, Dr. Bales, Tasha Barnes Griffin, Mark Irvin, and Jim Well.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dr. O'Neill.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board president.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond standard consent agenda processing.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:07:49 Introduction of New Boys Basketball Coach**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff Holloway and Mr. Walker.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of Coach Justino as the new head boys basketball coach at Muncie Central High School, accompanied by his family. Discussion highlighted his previous coaching success (25-1 record, undefeated regular season, IBCA District 2 Coach of the Year) and goals to connect with lower and elementary level programs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Ceremonial introduction; no formal board action required.
- **[0023:16] Financial Report for April 2022**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of financial results for the first four months of the year. Noted receipt of the state basic grant (projecting just under \$42 million in revenue for the calendar year), no long-term debt payments due in April (\$2.4 million due in June), and a healthy ending cash balance of over \$33.5 million at the end of April (projecting over \$30 million by year-end). The education fund stands at over \$15 million. Ongoing payment of \$50,000/month toward the state loan (\$1.1 million paid to date). Early property tax draw received.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **[0028:40] Additional Appropriation Advertisement for Rainy Day Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for permission to advertise for a public hearing for an additional appropriation out of the Rainy Day Fund (balance over \$12 million) to cover emergency capital items and begin paying back the state loan from this fund rather than the education fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **[0030:09] SSC Contract Renewal Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of the annual contract renewal amendment with SSC (outside vendor for custodial and maintenance facilities duties). The amendment reflects a 5% increase over the prior year due to inflation and workforce stabilization efforts, valued at \$3,831,192. Discussion ensued regarding prevailing wages, starting pay rates (\$11+), labor market challenges, and future internal cost comparisons.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

- **[037:34] Construction Manager Contract for Westview Elementary Renovation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome and Dave Heater.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to award a construction manager contract to Core Construction (CGA and Associates) for the Westview Elementary renovation project (2022<U+2013>2024). Funded entirely through federal ESSER funds expiring in September 2024. Westview represents the final of three major building projects (following Mitchell/EWA and Southview), focusing on footprint expansion, traffic flow, and additional classrooms.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **[044:39] Legacy Life Security Agreement (SRO Services)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome and Chuck.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of an external security agreement with Legacy Life Security (led by Pastor Robert Scafe) to formalize School Resource Officer (SRO) and security services across district schools for the upcoming school year. Praised for stepping up during previous district crises.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **[053:29] Public Hearing on the Lease (Building Corporation / Football Stadium Project)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome / Board President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Statutory public hearing pursuant to Indiana Code 20-47-3 regarding the execution of a lease between the Muncie Multi-School Building Corporation and Muncie Community Schools. The project encompasses a complete tear-down and rebuild of the Muncie Central High School football stadium, installation of an all-weather turf field, above-ground locker/restroom facilities, and electrical/HVAC improvements at the fieldhouse, financed via bonds structured to avoid tax rate increases by timing them with expiring debt.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **[067:02] Ricky Yinzer** (Former city councilman and author) spoke during the public hearing, questioning the timing and necessity of a ~\$6 million stadium project relative to academic metrics, cash balances, and potential taxpayer debt impacts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing closed. Resolution to execute the lease subsequently Approved by Voice Vote.
- **[111:55] Additional Appropriation Hearing & Resolution (Building Project Bonds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Public hearing and subsequent resolution authorizing an additional appropriation from bond proceeds for school facility improvements, including the Muncie Central stadium rebuild, hvac, roofing, site work, and equipment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**

- [114:00] **Ricky Yinzer** reiterated concerns regarding taxpayer funding and advocated for the utilization of local union labor on public construction projects.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing closed. Resolution Approved by Voice Vote.
 - [115:32] **Assignment of Construction Bids**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution (Exhibit C) providing for the formal assignment of future construction bids to the Building Corporation once specifications and bidding processes are completed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - [116:08] **Master Continuing Disclosure Undertaking & Post-Issuance Compliance Procedures**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolutions (Exhibits D and E) establishing formal post-issuance compliance and continuing disclosure procedures required following bond sales.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [015:38] **Ricky Yinzer** addressed the board regarding the district's cash balances (~\$35 million), questioning the proposed ~\$6 million expenditure on the 1950s-era football stadium, potential tax rate impacts, and interactions with other public facilities.
 - [017:08] **Akilah** (representing the Muncie Public Library) congratulated the board on receiving the Next Generation School Improvement Grant, highlighted ongoing literacy partnerships, the "READ" card system for students, and requested partnership consideration for after-school programming at Southview and Grissom schools.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds provided updates on Teacher of the Year announcements, IHSAA track tournament participation (approx. 30 athletes in regionals), Bandarama events, statehouse literacy meetings with state officials, and a new manufacturing/automation career center pathway partnership.
 - Celebrated the Muncie Southside Vex Robotics team and their participation in the world championships in Dallas, Texas.

- Board members extended appreciation to faculty, staff, and leadership for navigating a challenging post-COVID school year.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following closing remarks.
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